SEMPLICE ITALIAN KITCHEN | REGIONAL ITALIAN RECIPES

Authentic Bolognese Gramigna con Salsiccia (20-Minute Curly Sausage Pasta)

PREP: 5 mins | COOK: 15 mins | TOTAL: 20 mins | SERVINGS: 4 servings | CALORIES: 580 kcal

INGREDIENTS

* 400g (14 oz) Gramigna Pasta (or Bronze-die Cavatappi)
* 350g (12 oz) Mild Italian Pork Sausage (casings removed, crumbled fine)
* 1 small Yellow Onion or Shallot (finely minced)
* 1 tbsp Extra-Virgin Olive Oil & 15g (1 tbsp) Unsalted Butter
* 80ml (1/3 cup) Dry White Wine
* 1.5 tbsp Double-Concentrated Tomato Paste (or 1/3 cup Passata)
* 60ml (1/4 cup) Heavy Cream (Panna da Cucina) (optional, or use extra pasta water + butter)
* 75g (3/4 cup) Parmigiano-Reggiano DOP (24-month aged) (freshly grated)
* 1 pinch Freshly Grated Nutmeg & Black Pepper

STEP-BY-STEP INSTRUCTIONS

Step 1: Sweat the Onion in Butter & Olive Oil (3 mins)

Warm the olive oil and butter in a wide skillet over medium heat. Add the finely minced onion and cook for 3 minutes until soft and translucent.

Step 2: Brown the Sausage Crumbles & Deglaze (8 mins)

Increase heat to medium-high and add the crumbled Italian pork sausage. Sear for 6-7 minutes, using a wooden spoon to break the sausage into small pebble-sized bits until deeply golden-brown. Pour in the dry white wine and simmer for 2 minutes until evaporated.

Step 3: Caramelize Tomato Paste & Simmer with Pasta Water (4 mins)

Meanwhile, boil the gramigna (or cavatappi) in salted water. Stir the tomato paste and a tiny pinch of grated nutmeg into the browned sausage for 60 seconds, then ladle in 1/2 cup of starchy pasta water (and the optional 1/4 cup of heavy cream). Simmer gently for 3 minutes into a glossy blush rag.

Step 4: Toss & Finish with Aged Parmigiano-Reggiano (2 mins)

Transfer the al dente pasta directly into the sausage skillet. Toss over medium heat for 60 seconds so the sauce fills the hollow pasta curls. Remove from the heat, fold in the grated 24-month Parmigiano-Reggiano and freshly cracked black pepper, and serve piping hot.

NONNA'S CHEF TIPS:

- Take an extra minute to break the raw sausage into tiny pea-sized crumbles in the pan-smaller crumbles cling inside the curved pasta tubes instead of sinking to the bottom of the bowl.
- A tiny grating of fresh nutmeg is a signature Emilia-Romagna secret that makes pork and Parmigiano taste twice as rich.